lawyers, judges, students and the civil society in a struggle to restore the chief justice of Pakistan; the movement became an important factor in the downfall of the Musharraf regime.

However, the role of the military courts is primarily to deal with terrorism and impose the death penalty, despite the fact that there is no clarity about the identity of the individuals who have been executed by these courts. Yet, many of those interviewed in this research support the death penalty and had complete confidence in the military courts: '*If you are the mother of one of the children killed in the Peshawar attack, you would want to see them hanged*'; '*Avenge the family*'; '*Not just vengeance, it is about the law. Keep fear in those people*' (Focus Group, Private University[78]). '*Khoon ka badla khoon hai*[79] *according to Islam. Complete trust in the military courts*' (Focus Group, Government University[80]).

In one focus group, for example, out of forty respondents only three did not believe in the military courts (Focus Group, Government University[81]). A few pointed out that there is '*selective justice even in military courts*' or that it was '*Not really justice. Don't really serve for justice, since they are also political but better than nothing*' (Focus Group, Private University[82]). However, across the focus groups the majority of students believed that the military courts were useful, and that the death penalty was just and effective in combating terrorism in Pakistan.

The relationship between democracy and the army in Pakistan is more complex given the strength of the military and its involvement and influence over the Pakistani state. Despite Pakistan having had a democratic transfer to the PML(N) after the PPP completed a full term in office, one student points out that '*problems are still there. Violence, terrorism, electricity shortage, water shortage, gas shortage.*' The state is not visible. '*People have basic needs. They do not want terrorism. Everyone blames the last party in power. We have had democracy for eight years. It has not done anything*' (Focus Group, Private University[83]).

The non-Muslim citizens

While the relationship between citizens and the state varies along lines of class and ethnicity, religion is also an important factor, especially when it is clearly written in the constitution of Pakistan that the head of state can only be a Muslim. In March 2018 a 'Pakistani court ruled … that all citizens must declare their religion when applying for identity documents, a move human rights advocates say is another blow for the country's persecuted minority